Note: The full interactive tutorial is still in development. This guide bridges the gap and covers everything you need to know to get your hotel up and running.

🎯 What's the Goal?

You build and manage a hotel. Guests arrive, check in, eat, relax – and eventually check out. Your job: keep them happy so you earn money, level up, and expand your hotel further.

The game is an **economic simulation with visible life** – all guests and staff physically move through your hotel. There are no pure spreadsheet menus.

🚪 From the Main Menu to the Game

Before you see your hotel, you'll briefly go through the **main menu**:

1. Launch the Game

Start HO·MA·SIM. You land on the **main menu**.

2. Create or Select a Manager

On first launch, the **"Create Your Manager"** dialog opens. Here you set up your player profile:

- Enter a **Name**
- Choose **Gender** (Male / Female / Non-binary)
- Choose **Skin tone** (Light / Medium / Dark)
- Choose **Hair color** (Blonde, Brown, Black, Light Blonde, Red, Grey)
- Choose **Outfit** (Black Suit / Grey Suit / Casual / Uniform)

On the right you'll see a **pixel art preview** of your manager. Confirm with **"Create Manager"**.

On subsequent launches you can directly select your existing manager – the last used one stays saved.

3. "Your Hotels" – Hotel Overview

After selecting your manager, **"Your Hotels"** opens – your personal hotel overview. You'll see:

- **Left:** Your manager card with avatar, name, level and number of hotels
- **Centre/Right:** All your hotel saves as cards with preview image and quick stats:
  - **Level** – your current hotel level
  - **Day** – how many in-game days have passed
  - **Guests** – currently checked-in guests
  - **Rep** – your reputation value
  - **Capital** – current balance
- The **"+"** tile creates a new hotel
- The **"×"** on a card deletes that hotel

4. Create a New Hotel

In the **"Create New Hotel"** dialog you configure your game:

Hotel Name: Give your hotel a name (required).

Difficulty – choose one of four modes:

Mode	Description
Easy	More starting capital, less pressure
Standard	Balanced start (€50,000 starting capital)
Hard	Less capital, higher challenge
Custom	All values manually adjustable (arrow keys)

In **Custom** mode you can fine-tune all values with ← / → arrows:

- **Starting Capital** – your initial budget
- **Construction Refund** – how much % you get back when demolishing
- **EXP Boost** – experience point multiplier
- **Room Dirt Rate** – how quickly rooms get dirty
- **Room Degradation** – how quickly rooms take damage

Starting Plot: On the right you'll see a preview of your starting plot including the lobby entrance side.

Confirm with **"Create"** (green) or cancel with **"Cancel"** (red).

5. Start Playing

After creating, your hotel appears as a new card in "Your Hotels". Click on it to load it – the game starts and you land directly in your hotel. You're the manager now!

What you see on first launch:

- The game starts **automatically paused** (display: "### Game Paused ###") – take a moment to get your bearings
- You see your **empty starting plot** (grey area = buildable land, green = non-buildable outside area)
- In the corner your **Lobby** is already placed – that's all you start with

💡 **Build some rooms first** before you unpause the game! Without rooms, no guests will arrive. The build menu is always visible at the bottom and automatically pauses the game when used.

- A hint appears at the top: **"Reception opens (07:00)"** – the first wave of guests arrives at 07:00
- When you're ready: press ▶ (top right) to start the game

🖥️ The HUD – What Do You See on Screen?

Top Bar (left to right)

Element	Meaning
Number + ☆☆☆☆☆	Your current hotel level + star rating
💰 **Amount**	Current capital (balance)
Counter	Active guests
0 / 150	EXP progress to next level
500 / 1000	Reputation points
📅 **1**	Current in-game day
06:00	Current in-game time
⏸ ▶ ▶▶	Game speed: Pause / Normal / Fast-Forward

💡 **Auto-Pause:** All F-menus (F1–F10) and the build menu automatically pause the game when opened. You can build, manage staff, or browse the tech tree without time passing.

Icon Bar – Top Right (F-Keys)

All main menus are also accessible by clicking their icons:

Key	Function
F1	**Reception** – Check-In / Check-Out overview
F2	**Tech Tree** – research & unlock new features
F3	**Guest List** – all current guests & their status
F4	**Room List** – all rooms, cleanliness, condition
F5	**Staff** – hire, fire, assign employees
F6	**Cash Book** – income & expenses
F7	**SimBrowser** – in-game browser
F8	**Quest Book** – active goals & milestones
F9	Hotel Overview *(not yet implemented)*
F10	**Tutorial / Codex** – reference & help
L	**Activity Log** – chronological event log
ESC	Close current menu / open pause menu
Home	Centre view on lobby

Left Sidebar – Overlays & Filters

Toggles coloured overlay views on the play field. Each click enables/disables the filter:

Overlay	Shows...
Dirt	How dirty each room is
Condition	Wear & repair needs
Occupancy	Which rooms are currently occupied
Room Categories	Rooms colour-coded by type
Value	Quality rating of rooms
WiFi	WiFi coverage in the hotel
Climate	Air conditioning coverage

Right Side (below top bar)

- **Activity Log** (also via L) – opens the chronological event log

Play Field (Centre)

- **Grey area** = your buildable plot
- **Green area** = non-buildable outside land

Camera Controls:

Action	Key
Move camera	WASD or arrow keys
Zoom	Mouse wheel or Numpad + / -
Centre view	Home

Build Menu (bottom, always visible)

Tab	Category
🛏	**Beds & Rooms**
🍴	**Gastronomy** (Bar, Kitchen, Restaurant)
🏠	**Management** (Staff)
💆	**Wellness** (Pool, Gym, Spa)
💼	**Business** (Conference)
🔨	**Demolish Tool** – tear down rooms
➕	**Buy Plot** – expand your land

🔨 Building – How It Works

Placing a Room

1. Select the desired category (tab) in the **build menu at the bottom**
2. Click the room type – it now follows your mouse as a **ghost**
3. Move the mouse over the plot and click to place

Ghost Colours

Colour	Meaning
🟩 **Green**	Placement possible – you can build here
🟥 **Red**	Placement not possible – reason usually shown in tooltip

Room Variants

After selecting a room type, a bar with **variants** appears at the bottom (e.g. different room sizes). Click a variant to select it.

Build Shortcuts

Key	Function
R	Rotate room
. (Period)	Cycle door position
Shift (hold)	Multi-build – after placing, the room stays selected so you can keep building
ESC or RMB	Cancel build mode

⚠️ Important: There Are No Corridor Pieces!

There are **no separate corridor elements** to build. Hallways form automatically through the **natural gaps** between rooms – so leave some space when placing rooms so your guests and staff can move through your hotel.

🚀 First Steps – One at a Time

Step 1: Understand Your Hotel

You start with a **Lobby** (already built). The lobby is your reception – all guests arrive here and check out here. You **cannot demolish** the lobby.

Step 2: Build Rooms

Without rooms, no guests arrive. The **build menu is always visible at the bottom** – nothing to open:

1. Select the **Rooms** tab in the build menu
2. Place at least **2–3 Single Rooms** (cheap, no prerequisites)
3. Make sure rooms connect to the lobby or are reachable via a corridor

Cost: Single Room = €2,000 | Income: ~€80 / night

Step 3: Hire Staff (from Level 2)

Nothing works without staff. But first: **you need a Staff Room!**

Order:

1. Build a **Small Staff Room** (€2,500, unlocked at Level 2) → Each staff room lets you hire 4 employees
2. Open F5 (Staff Management)
3. Hire a **Housekeeper** → cleans rooms after checkout
4. Optional: a **Maintenance Worker** → repairs broken objects

Without a housekeeper: Guests check into dirty rooms → bad reviews!

Step 4: Receive Guests

When new guests arrive, the **game automatically pauses** and a toast notification "New Guests" appears. Check-in and checkout always go through the **Reception (Lobby)**:

- Click on the **Lobby** → the reception menu opens
- There you see waiting guests and can process **Check-In** and **Checkout**

In early stages **you personally** handle the reception desk. This is intentional! Later, tech tree upgrades enable automatic check-in and checkout.

💡 **Observe guests:** Click directly on a guest in the hotel to open a **PiP camera** with their current status values (hunger, thirst, satisfaction, etc.). You can have up to **3 PiP windows open at once**.

Step 5: Provide Food & Drinks (optional but important)

Hungry guests get unhappy quickly. The lobby snack machine helps briefly but won't cut it long-term.

Gastronomy order (Tech Tree):

1. **Bar** (research G1.1 → €1,800, needs bartender)
2. **Kitchen** (G1.2 → €3,000, needs chef)
3. **Restaurant** (G1.3 → €5,000, needs waiter)

⚠️ The restaurant only works with an active kitchen + chef + waiter. Don't build the restaurant without also running the kitchen!

💡 Key Game Mechanics

Guest Needs

Every guest has needs: **Hunger, Thirst, Fatigue, Fun**. If these aren't met, **satisfaction** drops. At very low satisfaction, the guest leaves a bad review and you lose reputation.

Click on a guest to open their PiP camera and see their current status.

Patience

Guests only wait a **limited time** for check-in, food, or a free seat. If they wait too long, they leave unsatisfied. Keep your operation running smoothly.

Cleanliness

Rooms get **dirty** after checkout. A housekeeper must clean the room before it can be occupied again. Broken objects are repaired by the maintenance worker.

Staff Morale

Employees lose morale through work. They recover in the **Staff Room**. Below 50% morale: slower. At 0%: they quit. Monitor your staff's morale in F5.

Money & Levelling

- **EXP** is earned through guest checkouts, completed quests and special actions
- Each **Level-Up** unlocks new tech tree features
- In the **Tech Tree** (F2) you spend research points on new rooms, bonuses and features

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❓ Frequently Asked Questions

"No guests are arriving!" → Make sure at least 1 room has been built. Wait a moment – guests don't arrive instantly.

"I can't hire any staff!" → Build a staff room first. No staff room = no staff capacity = no hiring possible.

"The restaurant is empty even though guests are around!" → Check: Do you have a kitchen with a chef? Do you have a waiter in the restaurant? Both are required!

"A room shows a warning symbol!" → Hover over the room with your mouse. The tooltip explains the problem (e.g. no staff assigned, broken object, too dirty).

"I see strange symbols on the rooms!" → These are status indicators: 🔧 = repair needed, 🧹 = cleaning needed, ⚠️ = no staff.

🗺️ Typical Daily Schedule

– Guests wake up, want breakfast

– Checkout wave: day-trip guests depart

– Restaurant & Bar open

– Housekeepers clean rooms, maintenance repairs – if assigned

– Lunchtime: Restaurant & Bar busy

– New guests arrive throughout the day

– Dinner: second restaurant rush

– Night hours, hotel quieter

– Nightly settlement: room income is credited

📋 Quick Reference: Rooms & Requirements

Room	Cost	Requirement	Income
Lobby	€0	– (already built)	–
Single Room	€2,000	none	~€80 / night
Double Room	€3,500	none	~€130 / night
Family Room	€6,000	Tech Tree Z1.2	~€200 / night
Superior Room	€15,000	Tech Tree Z1.3	~€400 / night
Staff Room	€2,500	Level 2	(required for staff)
Bar	€1,800	Tech Tree G1.1	~€15 / drink
Kitchen	€3,000	Tech Tree G1.2	(required for food)
Restaurant	€5,000	Tech Tree G1.3	~€25 / meal
Pool	€5,000	Tech Tree W1.2	(satisfaction ↑)
Gym	€3,800	Tech Tree	(satisfaction ↑)
Spa / Sauna	€4,500	Tech Tree W1.3	(satisfaction ↑)
Conference Room	€5,000	Tech Tree P1.2	Day guests

HO·MA·SIM Pre-Alpha v0.2.1 · This guide is preliminary and will be updated alongside the game.